



Deep learning: Latest trend in smart speakers

The global smart speaker market will grow annually at 24 per cent during the period 2017-21—forecasts a Research and Markets report. The latest trend gaining momentum in the market is deep-learning software—an advanced version of artificial intelligence (AI). The deep-learning software is capable of recognising image, sound and other data patterns. This capability is being exploited

by Google, among others, to build speech recognition software in its latest Android mobile software.

According to the report, one of the major smart speaker drivers is the increase in the number of smart homes in developed countries such as the US and the UK. In a smart home, smart electronics, consumer electronic devices, and media and entertainment gadgets connect to the home network and interact with each other.

Localised smartphone manufacturing to reach 25 per cent by 2019: IAMA

In the backdrop of a strong growth potential for smartphone adoption, India is set to increase its domestic localisation rate from 6.1 per cent in 2016 to 25.8 per cent in 2019, according to a report published jointly by the Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMA) and Enixta Innovations. This translates to ₹ 310 billion in value generated through local sourcing and assembly. There is a high possibility to build local sourcing capabilities for mobile phone

components such as battery packs, non-electronic parts, accessories and packaging, though the main electronic components will take longer to be sourced locally.

According to the report, 38 new mobile manufacturing units were set up between September 2015 and October 2016. Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana have emerged as the mobile phone manufacturing hubs in the country with half of the 38 manufacturing units established in these states.

Smartphones constituted 43 per cent of total handset sales in 2016

The Indian handset market recorded over 350 million sales in the financial year 2016-17 as compared to 280 million in 2015-16, according to an ASSOCHAM-KPMG joint study. Smart phones, in particular, have gained immense popularity in India in the last four years and

constituted 43 per cent of the total handset shipments in 2016. Robust growth of the handset market coupled with enhanced connectivity of telecom services have been pivotal in growth of various industries such as retail, manufacturing, IT, e-commerce, etc, noted the study.

On The Move

Infosys CEO and MD Sikka resigns

The Board of Directors of Infosys have accepted the resignation of Dr Vishal Sikka as the managing director and CEO.

Dr Sikka cited among his reasons for leaving a continuous stream of distractions and disruptions preventing the management's ability to accelerate the company's transformation. He will now serve the company as executive vice chairman, and will hold office until the new CEO and MD takes charge.

Intex appoints Rumpa as head of business excellence

Intex Technologies has appointed Rumpa Roy as head of business excellence. In her new role at Intex, Roy would be responsible for working on process efficiency enhancement. She will also be focusing on business process mapping/re-engineering. One of her key responsibilities is to drive strategic initiatives with functional heads.

Enphase appoints account manager in India

Enphase Energy, Inc., a global energy technology company and supplier of solar microinverters, has appointed a strategic account manager in India, added Sun-AP Ecopower and Redington as new distribution partners, and established a direct presence in Chennai to manage future growth in India.

As account manager for India, Venkata Mukundarajan will be responsible for driving distribution partnerships, supporting business development and expanding the preference for Enphase microinverters amongst installers.